

Meeting Special Education Needs with Open Source Software



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Children and adults with special needs require special education. Cboard is free and open source software for special children, but a lot of work is still needed in this domain, especially in India.

It is amazing to see how much selfless collective human effort can achieve. Let me give an example. Almost two decades ago, I got a CD-ROM of Encarta, a digital multimedia encyclopaedia released by Microsoft. At a time when dial-up connections were slow, internet speed was measured in kilobytes, and data was as precious as gold, this CD-ROM of Encarta was

a treasure trove of information for me, a young man from a small village in Kerala. If somebody had told me that within a decade Encarta would be a commercial failure and go out of business because of an encyclopaedia written by volunteers working for free, I wouldn't have believed them. Encarta had articles written by experts in their respective fields who were paid for